

READ THE COMPANY'S NEWSLETTER AND FIX THE SIX ERRORS.

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1

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2

SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

PRESENTER:
FACULTY OF GENERAL EDUCATION
DIHPE



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3

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Identify the subject and verb in a sentence.

Apply the rules of subject-verb agreement to ensure that the verb from matches the subject in number.



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4

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

■ Examples:

The condition of the teeth **is** improving after treatment.

The result of the experiments **was** significant for oral cancer research.

The appearance of the gums **depends** on proper oral hygiene.

- Subject with a phrase or a clause → the verb agrees with the head noun.



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5

■ Examples:

The dentist and the hygienist **work** together during the procedure.

Caries and gingivitis **are** common among young patients.

The patient or the parent **is** responsible for the payment.

The dentist or the assistants **are** responsible for sterilizing instruments.

- Compound subjects joined by “and” → plural verb
- Compound subjects joined by “or” → verb agrees with the nearest subject



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6

• Examples:

Everyone in the clinic **is** wearing protective gear.

Few of the patients **have** reported pain after extraction.

None of the employees have brought their children to the company dinner.

None of the student is interested in the research project.

- The indefinite pronouns or adjectives **either, neither, and each**, as well as compounds such as **everybody, anybody, everyone, and anyone, something, and nothing**, are always singular.
- **Plural indefinite pronouns** (several, few, both, many)+ **plural verbs**
- **Some indefinite pronouns are singular or plural** (some, any, none, all, most), **so uncountable + singular verb and countable + plural verb.**

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- Use a singular verb after a plural amount of money, time, or distance when it refers to one thing or idea (a price, a time, a period, or a distance).

• Examples:

Ten years **is** a long time to go without a dental check-up.

• Fifty dollars **is** the cost of the consultation.

• Three kilometers **is** the distance from the hostel to the dental clinic.

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- Some nouns look plural but are used with a singular verb. For example:
- Subjects ending in –ics
- The noun 'news'

• Examples:

Gingivitis **is** a common gum disease.

■ Periodontics **is** a specialized field of dentistry.

■ News about oral health campaigns **is** encouraging.



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9

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- Use a singular verb with names of books, movies, and plays, countries and business ending in -s.

• Examples:

"Prosthodontics in Practice" **is** a required textbook.

• The United States **has** a highly advanced dental research program.



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10

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- Use a singular verb with "the number of".
- Use a plural verb with "a number of".

• Examples:

"The number of new patients **has** increased this month.

- A number of dental students **are** participating in the research.
- The number of root canals **is** higher than average.
- A number of instruments **were** sterilized before the surgery.



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11

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- Collective nouns as a single unit → singular verb
- Collective nouns emphasizing individuals → plural verb

• Examples:

The dental team **is** performing the surgery smoothly.

- The committee **are** giving their separate opinions on the research paper.
- The staff **is** working on sterilization procedures.
- The dental team **are** discussing their different roles in the operation.



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12

ACTIVITY—RULE HUNT

- “One of” at the beginning of the sentence → singular verb
- “One of ... who/that ...” (in the middle of the sentence) → plural verb

• Examples:

One of the dentists **is** presenting a case today.

• She is one of the dentists who **work** with pediatric patients.

• One of the patients **is** waiting in the recovery room.

• This is one of the methods that **are** commonly used in root canal therapy.



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13

Read each case study carefully. Identify the five subject–verb agreement errors in each paragraph. Underline the incorrect verb and write the correct form.

1. *A 52-year-old patient with uncontrolled diabetes presented to the periodontal clinic with persistent gingival bleeding. The clinical examination reveal generalized pocket depths of 6–8 mm, while several areas of furcation involvement was also detected. A series of periapical radiographs, along with a complete periodontal chart, were obtained before treatment was planned. The combination of poor oral hygiene and inadequate glycemic control contribute significantly to the progression of periodontal disease. In addition, the patient's previous dental records indicates that he had received little periodontal maintenance during the past five years.*

Key:

1. **reveals**

The subject *clinical examination* is singular.

2. **were**

Several areas is plural.

3. **was**

The main subject *a series* is singular.

4. **contributes**

The subject *combination* is singular.

5. **indicate**

Dental records is plural.



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14

2. A 24-year-old woman was referred to the oral surgery department because of recurrent pain associated with her lower third molars. The panoramic radiograph show that both mandibular wisdom teeth were partially impacted. Neither the patient nor her parents were aware that the teeth had developed in an abnormal position. The presence of pericoronitis, together with repeated episodes of facial swelling, suggest that surgical intervention may be necessary. Several factors, including the proximity of the inferior alveolar nerve and the degree of impaction, needs to be assessed before extraction. What concerns the surgeon most are the risk of nerve injury and postoperative complications.

Key:

1. **shows**
The panoramic radiograph is singular.
2. **was**
Neither...nor agrees with the nearer singular subject *patient*.
3. **suggests**
The subject *presence* is singular.
4. **need**
Several factors is plural.
5. **is**
The subject is the singular clause *What concerns the surgeon most*.

3. During the endodontic consultation, the dentist reviewed the patient's previous treatment records. The radiographs indicates that the first root canal treatment had failed to completely disinfect the canal system. A number of microorganisms is believed to have survived in the untreated anatomical spaces. The presence of an additional canal, as well as extensive calcification, make retreatment particularly challenging. Neither the previous operator's notes nor the original radiographs provides sufficient information about the canal anatomy. What appears to be the primary cause of the persistent infection are inadequate cleaning and incomplete obturation.

Key:

1. **indicate**
Radiographs is plural.
2. **are**
A number of microorganisms is plural.
3. **makes**
The main subject is *presence*, not *additional canal*.
4. **provide**
With neither...nor, the nearer subject *radiographs* is plural.
5. **is**
What appears to be the primary cause is a singular subject clause.

4. A 12-year-old boy was brought to the emergency dental clinic after falling during a school sports event. The clinical findings, together with the patient's description of the accident, **suggests** traumatic intrusion of the maxillary central incisor. Several small fragments of enamel **was** found on the patient's lips and inside the oral cavity. The condition of the periodontal ligament and the vitality of the affected tooth **requires** careful assessment. Neither the parents nor the accompanying teacher **was** able to provide information about whether the tooth had previously sustained trauma. A series of radiographs **were** taken to determine the extent of root damage and to rule out an alveolar fracture.

Key:

1. **suggest**
Clinical findings is plural.
2. **were**
Fragments is plural.
3. **require**
The compound subject *condition...and vitality* is plural.
4. **were**
With *neither...nor*, the nearer subject *teacher* is singular—but **teacher** is singular, so *was* is actually correct.
5. **was**
A series is treated as singular.



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17

5. Before fabrication of the definitive crown, the prosthodontist evaluated the patient's occlusion, periodontal condition, and remaining tooth structure. The quality of the clinical photographs, along with the accuracy of the diagnostic casts, **play** an important role in treatment planning. Neither the temporary crown nor the existing occlusal contacts **provide** adequate information about the patient's final functional requirements. A series of measurements **was** recorded to determine the appropriate vertical dimension. The patient's previous restorations, as well as the condition of the supporting teeth, **requires** careful evaluation before the final impression is taken. What complicates the treatment plan **are** the limited interocclusal space and the patient's parafunctional habits.

Key:

1. **plays**
The subject *quality* is singular; *accuracy* is additional information.
2. **provides**
Neither...nor agrees with the nearer singular subject *temporary crown*.
3. **were**
A series of measurements is often treated as singular in formal usage, so this is actually **not an error**.
4. **require**
Previous restorations + condition form a compound subject.
5. **is**
The subject *What complicates the treatment plan* is a singular clause.



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18

6. *Maintaining strict infection-control procedures* **are** *essential in every dental setting. A number of instruments used during surgical procedures* **requires** *sterilization according to established protocols. The dental assistant, together with the infection-control officer,* **monitor** *compliance with the clinic's sterilization guidelines. Neither contaminated instruments nor improperly sealed sterilization pouches* **is** *acceptable in the treatment area. The results of the biological monitoring tests* **provides** *important evidence about the effectiveness of the sterilization process. In addition, regular staff training and updated infection-control policies helps reduce the risk of cross-infection.*

Key:

1. **is**

Maintaining...procedures is a gerund phrase functioning as a singular subject.

2. **require**

A number of instruments is plural.

3. **monitors**

The main subject *dental assistant* is singular.

4. **are**

Neither...nor agrees with the nearer plural subject *pouches*.

5. **provide**

Results is plural.

THANK YOU

Reference:

Oxford Practice Grammar by John Eastwood